

MIDISTRUCT Parameter Guide by Artists and Styles

Complexity Settings

Type	Complexity	Why
Whispered voice (Billie Eilish)	2-3	Few notes, a lot of space
Standard pop voice	3-4	One note per syllable
Soul / ornamented voice	5-6	Melismas, passing notes
Melodic piano	4-5	Breathes less than a voice
Blues lead guitar	5-6	Bends, continuous ornaments
EDM Synth	5-6	No biological constraint
Jazz improvisation	6-8	Maximum ornaments
Orchestra / cinema	4-5	Simple for memorability

The Golden Rules of Complexity:

- The golden rule: a sung melody = the singer must breathe, articulate, and hold the notes. This naturally imposes silences and moderate density. An instrumental melody (synth, guitar, piano) doesn't have these biological constraints — it can be more continuous.
- The more the instrument resembles a human voice (flute, violin, voice), the lower the complexity should be.
- The more the instrument is purely electronic or percussive (lead synth, distorted electric guitar), the higher you can go. These tracks have a very syllabic and spaced-out melody — one note per syllable, lots of silences between phrases.

- **Taylor Swift / Vocal Pop → Complexity 3-4**

- These tracks have a very syllabic and spaced-out melody
- — one note per syllable, with plenty of silence between phrases.
- *Shake It Off*, *WANTBT*, *IKYWT* are all around 3-4 notes per measure on the lead.
- The melody breathes, giving the impression that the voice "floats" above the accompaniment.

- **Mid-tempo Pop (Happier, Payphone, Titanium) → Complexity 4-5**

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- Slightly denser, with a few passing notes, but still plenty of space.
- This is the most versatile setting for modern pop.
- **EDM / House / Linkin Park → Complexity 5-6**
- Marshmello (*Happier*), Swedish House Mafia, Numb — the melody is more continuous, with fewer silences and a few runs.
- The lead synth in EDM often holds long notes but with more ornamentation.
- **R&B / Soul / Neo-soul → Complexity 6-7**
- R&B melodies are the most intricate — featuring melismas, chromatic passing notes, and interlocking phrases.
- This is the only genre where a complexity of 7 is truly justified.

Style	Complexity	Character
Taylor Swift / Stripped-down pop	3-4	Syllabic, airy
Mid-tempo pop	4-5	Balanced
EDM / Rock / House	5-6	More continuous
R&B / Soul	6-7	Dense, ornamental
Trap / Lo-Fi	3-4	Very sparse

- And Style 2 with a mix can refine even further — for example 1,4,30 (Pop + 30% R&B) will give you a slightly more ornamental pop without going all the way to pure R&B.

Workflow Tips (REAPER Settings)

- **The BPM** — you change the tempo in REAPER and everything follows automatically. MIDI generated at 124 BPM Pop instantly becomes 95 BPM for a groovier mid-tempo, or 108 BPM for tropical house. The PPQ positions do not move, only the temporal interpretation changes.
- **Transposition** — you select all MIDI items on a track, Ctrl+A in the piano roll, Shift+Up/Down arrow to change the key. A generation in C major becomes D major in two seconds. Useful if you want the melody to be in the comfortable register of a specific singer.

- **Swing** — in REAPER, the groove quantize can add or remove swing after the fact on any track. You generate in straight Pop (12% swing) and push it to 25-35% for a more R&B feel, without regenerating.
- **Global Velocity** — you can flatten or dynamize the velocities on an entire track with REAPER's normalize velocity. If the melody sounds too mechanical, a slight random humanize of ± 8 velocity adds life.
- The script always generates the same harmonic structure regardless of the style — it's the BPM, swing, and drum patterns that change.

So a Pop generation at 124 BPM with the chords Am F C G can become:

- Lo-fi just by slowing down to 85 BPM and swinging the drums to 35%
 - R&B by going up to 92 BPM and adding a bit of groove quantize
 - House by keeping 124 BPM and quantizing the kick to strict 4/4
 - Trap by going up to 140 BPM and making the melody sparser by hand
- Generate with the noted seed, test several BPMs on the same generation before touching anything else.

Often the right speed completely changes the emotional perception of the track

A complexity 4 melody generated in Pop can become Coldplay at 138 BPM or Lewis Capaldi at 85 BPM just by changing the tempo in REAPER.

Artists & Genres Breakdown

Taylor Swift (1989/Folklore era)

- Style 1 | Complexity 3 | Preset 2 (Am F C G) or 3
- Very syllabic melody, one note = one syllable, marked silences between phrases. Few ornaments.
- The strength comes from the repetition of the hook, not from the density.

Ed Sheeran

- Style 1 | Complexity 4 | Preset 1 (C G Am F)
- *Shape of You, Perfect* — folk-pop melody, simple contour, a lot of notes on downbeats and silence on off-beats.
- Very present walking bass.

Adele

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- Style 4 | Complexity 4 | Preset 5 (Am G F G)
- *Hello, Someone Like You* — sober soul melody with a few ornaments only on phrase endings.
- A lot of space in the Verse, denser in the Chorus.

Coldplay

- Style 1 | Complexity 3 | Preset 5 or 6
- *The Scientist, Fix You* — minimalist melody, long sustained notes, very few passing notes. Very present piano pad.

Dua Lipa

- Style 1 | Complexity 5 | Preset 2 (Am F C G)
- BPM 124 | Swing 12%
- *Levitating, Don't Start Now* — disco-pop melody with light syncopation, repetitive hook, active counter-melody in the silences.
- This is the native Style 1 of MIDISTRUCT.

The Weeknd

- Style 1 mix Style 4 at 30% | Complexity 5 | Preset 5
- *Blinding Lights, Save Your Tears* — pop melody with a slight R&B color.
- Long notes in the Verse, more active in the Chorus. High register (falsetto voice).

Ariana Grande

- Style 4 | Complexity 5 | Preset 2 or 10 (Soul Am7)
- *Thank U Next, 7 Rings* — pop with a very marked R&B base, a few melismas on phrase endings.
- Very active syncopated bass.

Katy Perry

- Style 1 | Complexity 4 | Preset 1 (C G Am F)
- *Roar, Firework* — very straightforward pop, simple and repetitive hook, predictable but effective melody. Little harmonic surprise.

Maroon 5

- Style 1 mix Style 4 at 20% | Complexity 5 | Preset 1 or 3
- *Payphone, Sugar* — slightly funky pop, active bass, mid-density melody.
- Adam Levine has a voice in a high register but the lines remain simple.

Billie Eilish

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- Style 1 mix Style 3 at 40% | Complexity 3 | Preset 5 (Am G F G)
- BPM 90-120 | Random seed
- *Bad Guy, Happier Than Ever* — whispered voice very close to the mic, extremely sparse melody, lots of intentional silence.
- The production does all the work around it. Complexity 3 is the right setting, even 2 if you really want to stick to the style.

Lana Del Rey

- Style 1 mix Style 3 at 50% | Complexity 3 | Preset 7 (Andalusian Am G F E)
- BPM 70-90
- *Summertime Sadness, Video Games* — very slow cinematic pop, long melody with sustained notes of 2-4 bars, very few notes per bar.
- The 50% Lo-Fi mix gives the characteristic melancholic texture.

Sia

- Style 1 | Complexity 4 | Preset 2 (Am F C G)
- BPM 124-130
- *Chandelier, Titanium* — powerful voice but structured pop melody, highly repetitive hook.
- More density than Billie Eilish but still within vocal silences. The Chorus is dense, the Verse very airy.

Sam Smith

- Style 4 | Complexity 4 | Preset 5 or 8
- BPM 80-95
- *Stay With Me, Writing's on the Wall* — soul-pop with voice in a high register, sober melody with a few ornaments only on phrase endings.
- No aggressive melismas.

Lewis Capaldi

- Style 1 | Complexity 3 | Preset 5 (Am G F G)
- BPM 75-90
- *Someone You Loved, Before You Go* — very stripped-down pop ballad, slow syllabic melody, simple chords.
- One of the most minimalist styles in contemporary pop.

James Arthur

- Style 1 mix Style 4 at 25% | Complexity 4 | Preset 2

- BPM 90-110
- *Say You Won't Let Go, Impossible* — emotional pop with a slight soul color, more developed melody than Lewis Capaldi but still sober.

🎵 R&B / Soul — Complexité 4-6

Beyoncé

- Style 4 | Complexity 6 | Preset 10 (Am7 D9 Gmaj7)
- BPM 92-100
- *Crazy in Love, Halo* — R&B with frequent ornaments, melismas on phrase endings, very groovy bass with syncopations.
- Complexity 7 is justified.

Bruno Mars

- Style 4 | Complexity 5 | Preset 4 (50s C Am F G) or Preset 10
- *Just the Way You Are, Locked Out of Heaven* — very clean pop-soul.
- More regular melody than Beyoncé but with characteristic small ornaments on the Choruses.

Frank Ocean

- Style 4 mix Style 3 at 25% | Complexity 5 | Preset 11 (Neo-Soul Dm9)
- BPM 75-90
- *Pyramids, Thinkin Bout You* — neo-soul with advanced harmony (9ths, 11ths), melody that floats over sophisticated chords.
- The Lo-Fi mix gives the introspective side.

SZA

- Style 4 mix Style 3 at 30% | Complexity 5 | Preset 11
- BPM 80-95
- *Kill Bill, Good Days* — modern neo-soul, voice in a medium-high register, melody with many chromatic passing notes.

John Legend

- Style 4 | Complexity 4 | Preset 9 (Jazz Dm7 G7 Cmaj7)
- *All of Me, Ordinary People* — classic soul with a jazz base, sober voice in the Verse and expressive in the Chorus.
- Preset 9 or 10 are ideal.

Rock / Alt-Rock — Complexité 4-6

Imagine Dragons

- Style 7 | Complexity 5 | Preset 13 (Rock Am F C G)
- BPM 120-140
- *Believer, Radioactive* — anthemic rock, mid-density melody, lots of space in the Verse and explosion in the Chorus.
- Permanent open hi-hat characteristic of the Rock style.

Linkin Park

- Style 7 mix Style 6 at 20% | Complexity 5 | Preset 14 (Rock Power Am G F)
- BPM 100-120
- *Numb, In the End* — rock with a slight electronic color.
- Sober melody in the Verse (Complexity 4 for the Verse), very dense in the Chorus.
- The Trap mix gives the electro color of the drums.

Green Day

- Style 7 | Complexity 4 | Preset 12 (Rock A D E)
- BPM 150-180
- *Good Riddance, Boulevard of Broken Dreams* — very direct punk-pop, fast syllabic melody, few ornaments, power chords.
- Low complexity because the notes go fast.

Coldplay (Rock era)

- Style 7 mix Style 1 at 40% | Complexity 4 | Preset 5
- BPM 138
- *The Scientist, Viva la Vida* — atmospheric rock with pop color. The 40% Pop mix gives the characteristic soft melodic side.

EDM / House / Electro — Complexité 5-6

David Guetta / Calvin Harris

- Style 5 | Complexity 5 | Preset 16 (House Am C G F)
- BPM 124-128

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- *Titanium, Summer* — classic house, laid-back mid-density vocal melody on a 4/4 kick.
- The Chorus is often instrumental (drop) so the pad and counter-melody do the work.

Swedish House Mafia

- Style 5 | Complexity 6 | Preset 16
- BPM 126-128
- *Don't You Worry Child, One* — progressive house, very repetitive and simple melody but with more electronic ornaments.
- The pad in swell is crucial.

Marshmello

- Style 5 mix Style 1 at 30% | Complexity 5 | Preset 2
- BPM 100-110
- *Happier, Alone* — future bass / electronic pop, simple pop melody laid over an EDM production.
- The House+Pop mix is exactly the right balance.

Martin Garrix

- Style 5 | Complexity 6 | Preset 17 (Techno Am F C G)
- BPM 128
- *Animals, Scared to Be Lonely* — progressive house with techno elements, denser synthetic melody, characteristic hi-hat in swell.

🎧 Lo-Fi / Chill — Complexité 3-4

Typical Lo-Fi (Lofi Girl, ChilledCow)

- Style 3 | Complexity 3 | Preset 11 (Neo-Soul Dm9) or 9 (Jazz)
- BPM 75-90
- Very sparse pentatonic melody, lots of silence, long sustained notes.
- Ride cymbal instead of the hi-hat (activated automatically in style 3). It is the most minimalist style.

Nujabes / J Dilla influence

- Style 3 mix Style 4 at 35% | Complexity 4 | Preset 9 or 10
- BPM 80-92

- Jazz hip-hop, very marked swing (35%), sophisticated harmony with 9ths and 11ths on the chords.

🎧 Trap / Urban — Complexité 3-5

Drake

- Style 6 mix Style 4 at 25% | Complexity 4 | Preset 5 (Minor Am G F)
- BPM 135-145
- *God's Plan, Hotline Bling* — mid-tempo trap with R&B color, very sparse sung-rapped melody, minimal bass with 808 kick. Low complexity because the silences are intentional.

Travis Scott

- Style 6 | Complexity 4 | Preset 14 (Rock Power)
- BPM 140-150
- *Sicko Mode, Goosebumps* — atmospheric trap, very reduced melody with autotune, dark vibe. Preset 14 gives the characteristic minor color.

Post Malone

- Style 6 mix Style 1 at 35% | Complexity 5 | Preset 13
- BPM 140-150
- *Circles, Sunflower* — trap with very singable pop melodies. The 35% Pop mix is essential to have the hooked melody over a trap background.

💡 Combos hybrides

Tropical House (Kygo, Thomas Rhett)

- Style 5 mix Style 3 at 20% | Complexity 5 | Preset 1 or 16
- BPM 100-108

Future Bass (Flume, Illenium)

- Style 5 mix Style 4 at 30% | Complexity 6 | Preset 10 or 11
- BPM 95-110

Indie Pop (Tame Impala, Vampire Weekend)

- Style 1 mix Style 3 at 30% | Complexity 4 | Preset 7 (Andalusian) or 6
- BPM 120-135

Pop Punk (Paramore, Blink-182)

- Style 7 | Complexity 4 | Preset 12 or 4 (50s)
- BPM 160-185

Synthwave (The Midnight, Kavinsky)

- Style 2 mix Style 1 at 40% | Complexity 5 | Preset 5 or 7
- BPM 110-120

Piano / Instrument mélodique → Complexité 4-6

Ludovico Einaudi

- Style 1 mix Style 3 at 60% | Complexity 4 | Preset 9 (Jazz Dm7 G7 Cmaj7)
- BPM 60-80
- Minimalist piano, repetitive and hypnotic melody, arpeggios in the pad.
- Complexity 4 but with long notes — it's the duration that compensates for the density.

Yann Tiersen

- Style 3 mix Style 1 at 30% | Complexity 5 | Preset 6 (Am Dm G C)
- BPM 100-120
- *Comptine d'un autre été* (Amélie) — classical-folk piano, repetitive melody with subtle variations, very rhythmic.
- More notes than Einaudi but still structured.

Hans Zimmer (Cinema themes)

- Style 1 mix Style 2 at 20% | Complexity 4 | Preset 7 (Andalusian)
- BPM 60-100
- *Interstellar*, *Inception* — simple and memorable orchestral melodies, often modal harmony. The Techno mix gives the dark and tense color

 Guitare lead / Rock mélodique → Complexité 5-7.

John Mayer

- Style 7 mix Style 4 at 40% | Complexity 6 | Preset 12 or 10
- BPM 90-110

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- *Gravity, Slow Dancing in a Burning Room* — blues-rock, lead guitar with lots of bends and passing notes, very expressive.
- The Rock+R&B mix is exactly his sound. Complexity 6 for solos, 5 for verses.

Eric Clapton / Classic Blues

- Style 7 mix Style 4 at 35% | Complexity 6 | Preset 15 (12 bars Blues A)
- BPM 80-120
- *Wonderful Tonight, Layla* — melodic blues, lead guitar with constant ornamentation.
- Preset 15 (12 bars Blues) is tailor-made for this style.

Dire Straits / Mark Knopfler

- Style 7 mix Style 4 at 30% | Complexity 5 | Preset 8 (Minor ii-V-i)
- BPM 95-115
- *Sultans of Swing, Money for Nothing* — rock-blues with complex picking but sober vocal melody.
- Complexity 5 on the sung melody, 6-7 on the lead guitar.

Pink Floyd

- Style 7 mix Style 1 at 35% | Complexity 4 | Preset 7 (Andalusian Am G F E)
- BPM 65-80
- *Wish You Were Here, Comfortably Numb* — atmospheric rock, very stripped-down vocal melody, expressive but spaced-out guitar solos.
- Silences are as important as the notes.

🎷 Jazz / Fusion → Complexité 6-8

Miles Davis (Kind of Blue)

- Style 3 mix Style 4 at 50% | Complexity 7 | Preset 9 (Jazz Dm7 G7 Cmaj7)
- BPM 80-120
- *So What, All Blues* — modal jazz, dense improvised melody with many chromatic passing notes.
- The Lo-Fi+R&B mix gives the acoustic texture and natural swing.

Norah Jones

- Style 3 mix Style 4 at 40% | Complexity 5 | Preset 9 or 10
- BPM 80-100

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- *Come Away with Me, Don't Know Why* — very accessible jazz-pop, soft voice, simple melody over sophisticated harmony.
- Less dense than pure jazz.

Diana Krall

- Style 3 mix Style 4 at 45% | Complexity 6 | Preset 9
- BPM 90-110
- *The Look of Love, Fly Me to the Moon* — classic vocal jazz, ornamented melody with a few melismas, sophisticated piano accompaniment.

Styles du monde → Paramètres spéciaux

Flamenco / Spanish Music

- Style 7 mix Style 2 at 20% | Complexity 6 | Preset 7 (Andalusian Am G F E)
- BPM 120-160
- The Andalusian preset is exactly tailored for this — the i-VII-VI-V progression is the classic flamenco cadence.
- The Rock+Techno mix gives the characteristic tension and urgency.

Celtic Music / Irish Folk

- Style 7 mix Style 3 at 30% | Complexity 5 | Preset 4 (50s C Am F G)
- BPM 120-160
- Fast pentatonic melody, very rhythmic, few sophisticated chords. The Rock+Lo-Fi mix gives the acoustic and organic side.

Bossa Nova

- Style 3 mix Style 4 at 45% | Complexity 5 | Preset 9 or 11
- BPM 110-130 | Swing 20-25%
- *The Girl from Ipanema, Garota de Ipanema* — Brazilian jazz, soft melody with moderate swing, sophisticated harmony with 9ths and 11ths.
- Preset 11 (Neo-Soul) gives a similar harmony.

Musique de jeux vidéo / Cinéma → Complexité variable

RPG / Fantasy (Final Fantasy, Zelda)

- Style 1 mix Style 3 at 40% | Complexity 4 | Preset 5 or 7

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- BPM 80-120
- Memorable and simple melody, often pentatonic or modal, very marked repetition. The Pop+Lo-Fi mix gives the light orchestral texture.

Tension / Thriller (Inception, Dark Knight)

- Style 2 mix Style 1 at 20% | Complexity 5 | Preset 7 (Andalusian)
- BPM 60-100
- Dark modal harmony, minimalist melody, lots of texture in the pad.
- The Techno style with its Phrygian scale is perfect for creating tension.

Action / Epic (Marvel, Star Wars)

- Style 7 mix Style 2 at 25% | Complexity 5 | Preset 13 (Rock Am F C G)
 - BPM 120-160
 - Strong anthemic melody, simple and memorable hook, dense orchestration. The Rock+Techno mix gives the energy and epic tension.
-